



TRANSFER APPLICATION CHECKLIST & TIMELINE

Week-by-Week Timeline, Document Tracker,
and School-Specific Requirement Matrices

IvyAmbition

T14 Law School Admissions Consulting



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The Master Timeline

Transfer applications compress an enormous amount of work into a narrow window. Miss a deadline and you've lost a year. This timeline ensures nothing falls through the cracks.

August–December (1L Fall)

Focus on grades above all else. Attend office hours consistently with 2-3 professors. Keep a running document of achievements. Research transfer-friendly schools casually.

January

Fall grades released. Assess realistic targets based on class rank. Create your school list spreadsheet. Begin drafting personal statement.

February

Complete first draft of personal statement. Ask 2 professors for recommendations (give them 6+ weeks). Request official transcript from current school. Register for LSAC CAS if not already done.

March

Revise personal statement based on feedback. Tailor "Why X" essays for each school. Follow up with recommenders. Prepare dean's certification letter request.

April

Applications open at most schools. Submit your strongest targets first. Follow up on any incomplete materials. Continue performing in spring classes — some schools will see spring grades.

May

All applications submitted by mid-May at latest. Request spring transcript sent to LSAC as soon as grades post. Send any updates (law review selection, awards) as addenda.

June–July

Decisions arrive on rolling basis. Some schools (Harvard) don't decide until late July/August. Begin negotiating financial aid if multiple admits. Research housing at top choices.

August

Final decision deadline. Notify schools. Coordinate credit transfers. Secure housing. Prepare for 2L at your new school.

CHAPTER 02

Document Tracker

Document	Deadline	Status
LSAC CAS registration	January	
Official 1L transcript (fall)	February	
Personal statement (general)	March	
"Why X" essays (school-specific)	April	
Letter of Rec #1	April (6 wk lead)	
Letter of Rec #2	April (6 wk lead)	
Dean's certification letter	April	
Resume (updated for 1L)	April	
Diversity statement (if applicable)	April	
Spring transcript update	May (when available)	
Addenda (awards, law review)	May–June	

CHAPTER 03

School-Specific Requirements

Beyond the standard package (transcript, PS, 2 recs, resume), many schools require additional materials. **Check each school's transfer page individually** — requirements change yearly.

1

Dean's Certification

Required by nearly all schools. Your current school's dean confirms you're in good standing with no disciplinary issues. Request early — dean's offices can be slow.

2**Class Rank Statement**

Some schools want an official rank from your registrar rather than self-reported. Check if your school provides this and request it in advance.

3**Why X Essays**

Columbia, NYU, Michigan, and others ask for school-specific essays. Never skip these. They signal genuine interest and are often the deciding factor between equally qualified candidates.

4**Additional Recommendations**

Some schools accept a third rec. If you have a strong one (especially from a practicing attorney or judge if you clerked), submit it.

CHAPTER 04**Week-by-Week Action Plan**

Once you decide to apply (typically January after fall grades), here's the specific weekly cadence:

**W1
-2****Research and School List**

Finalize your target schools. Create a spreadsheet: school, deadline, required materials, specific essay prompts, recommender requirements.

**W3
-4****Recommenders and Drafting**

Ask professors for recs. Begin personal statement draft. Review model transfer essays if available.

**W5
-6**

Revision and Tailoring

Revise PS based on feedback. Write school-specific "Why X" essays. Request dean's certification.

**W7
-8**

Application Assembly

Complete all application forms. Upload documents to LSAC. Double-check every field.

**W9
-10**

Submit and Verify

Submit applications. Confirm all materials received. Send follow-up to recommenders if any are outstanding.

CHAPTER 05

Submission Checklist

- ☐ LSAC CAS report status confirmed complete for each school
- ☐ Official transcript received by LSAC
- ☐ Both recommendation letters submitted through LSAC
- ☐ Dean's certification letter submitted
- ☐ Personal statement uploaded (correct version for each school)
- ☐ Why X essay uploaded for every school that requires one
- ☐ Resume uploaded in PDF format
- ☐ All application form fields completed accurately
- ☐ Character and fitness disclosures 100% complete and accurate
- ☐ Application fee paid or fee waiver applied
- ☐ Confirmation email received from each school
- ☐ Calendar marked with each school's decision timeline



WANT APPLICATION REVIEW BEFORE SUBMITTING?

IvyAmbition offers Transfer Application Review — we check every component before you hit submit.

Book a free 15-minute consultation at ivyambition.com